

# Mind Buddy

## Pocket Mental-Health Companion — Complete User Manual

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Mind Buddy is a portable, voice-first companion device designed for people living with anxiety, depression, PTSD, ADHD, bipolar disorder, and schizophrenia — and for the caregivers who support them. It pairs a small ESP32-S3 hardware device with a secure web and mobile app so support is always one tap, or one spoken sentence, away.

This manual covers everything you need: getting started, every feature, the caregiver dashboard, troubleshooting, and safety information.

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# 1. What's in the box

- 1× Mind Buddy device (ESP32-S3 based, with OLED screen, microphone and speaker)
- 1× USB-C charging cable
- 1× Lanyard / wrist strap
- 1× Quick-start card with your unique 6-character pairing code

If anything is missing, contact your supplier before continuing setup.

# 2. Quick start (5 minutes)

## Step 1 — Power on

Plug the device into any USB-C charger. After ~3 seconds you will see the Mind Buddy logo and hear a soft chime. The screen shows your 6-character pairing code.

## Step 2 — Connect to Wi-Fi

On your phone or laptop, join the Wi-Fi network named **MindBuddy-Setup**. A setup page opens automatically (if not, open a browser and visit 192.168.4.1). Pick your home Wi-Fi, enter the password, and enter the caregiver's email address.

## Step 3 — Create your account

Visit the Mind Buddy app and sign up with an email and password. On first sign-in choose whether you are a **patient** or a **caregiver**.

## Step 4 — Pair the device

In the app, tap **Pair device** and type the 6-character code shown on the device screen. The device will confirm with a spoken "Pairing successful".

## Step 5 — Say hello

Hold the **TALK** button on the side of the device and say "Hello". Release the button. Mind Buddy will reply.

# 3. The device, button by button

| Button             | Short press          | Long press                         |
|--------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------|
| TALK (large round) | —                    | Hold to talk to Mind Buddy         |
| SOS (red)          | Toggle screen        | 3 s — sends SOS alert to caregiver |
| PREV               | Previous menu / song | —                                  |
| NEXT               | Next menu / song     | —                                  |

|        |                      |                                |
|--------|----------------------|--------------------------------|
| SELECT | Confirm / play-pause | Hold during boot — erase Wi-Fi |
|--------|----------------------|--------------------------------|

All buttons are tactile and labelled in raised print so the device is usable without looking at it.

## 4. Talking to Mind Buddy

Mind Buddy is voice-first. To speak to it:

- Hold the TALK button.
- Speak naturally — no wake word needed when you are holding TALK.
- Release the button when you finish your sentence.
- Mind Buddy will reply through the speaker, usually within 1–2 seconds.

Things you can say:

- "I feel anxious — can we do a breathing exercise?"
- "Play me something calm."
- "Tell me a joke."
- "Remind me to take my medication at 9 pm."
- "I just want to talk."

## 5. SOS — the crisis button

If you feel unsafe, press and **hold the red SOS button for 3 seconds**. The device will:

- Sound a clear alarm so you know it has triggered.
- Send a push notification to every paired caregiver.
- Send a backup email to the caregiver address you set during setup.
- Play a live siren in the caregiver app until they acknowledge it.

To cancel a false alarm, press **SELECT** within 5 seconds of triggering. After that, only a caregiver can acknowledge.

**Important:** Mind Buddy is not a replacement for emergency services. In a life-threatening situation, always also call your local emergency number.

## 6. Medication reminders

Set up to four daily medication times in the app or by voice ("Remind me to take my meds at 8 am"). At the scheduled time:

- The speaker plays a soft chime and a spoken prompt.
- The OLED screen shows the medication name.

- You confirm by pressing SELECT — this is logged for your caregiver.
- If ignored for 10 minutes, your caregiver gets a gentle notification.

## 7. Music, radio and jokes

Ask for a song ("play afrobeats"), a genre, or a curated radio station — lofi, calm, ambient, jazz, classical, piano, or news. Mind Buddy streams audio directly to its speaker.

Volume: use PREV / NEXT during playback. Stop: press SELECT.

Need a laugh? Just say "tell me a joke". Mind Buddy keeps a rotating library of clean, mood-aware jokes.

## 8. Mood tracking & calm exercises

Open the patient dashboard in the app to log your mood each day on a simple 1–5 scale. Over time you (and your caregiver if you share with them) can see trends and triggers.

Ask Mind Buddy for calm exercises any time:

- Box breathing (4-4-4-4).
- 5-4-3-2-1 grounding.
- Body scan.
- Short guided meditations (2–5 minutes).

## 9. The web & mobile app

The Mind Buddy app works in any modern browser and is also available as a progressive web app you can install on Android and iOS. It has two main views:

- **Patient dashboard** — mood log, medication schedule, chat with Mind Buddy, settings.
- **Caregiver dashboard** — live SOS alerts, mood history, medication compliance, secure chat.

Sign-in supports email/password and Google. Your data is encrypted in transit and at rest.

## 10. Caregiver dashboard

As a caregiver, you can pair with one or more patients using their 6-character code. Once paired you receive:

- Real-time SOS alerts with an audible siren until acknowledged.
- Daily mood summaries.
- Medication-compliance notifications.
- A private chat thread so you can check in without a phone call.

Caregivers cannot read the patient's conversations with the AI — those stay private.

## 11. Settings & personalisation

From the device's PREV / NEXT menu, or from the app, you can:

- Change the voice (Female, Male, Neutral, Warm).
- Toggle sound on/off.
- Set up to four medication reminders.
- Switch support mode (general, anxiety, depression, PTSD, ADHD, bipolar, schizophrenia).
- Pair or unpair caregivers.

## 12. Charging, cleaning & care

Battery life is approximately 18 hours of typical use. Charge with the supplied USB-C cable; a full charge takes about 90 minutes. The LED on the side glows amber while charging and green when full.

Wipe the device with a dry, soft cloth. Do not submerge in water or use solvents. The device is splash-resistant but not waterproof.

## 13. Privacy & data

- All voice recordings are processed for transcription and then immediately discarded.
- Chat messages between you and the AI are stored only on your account and never shared with caregivers.
- Mood, medication and SOS events are shared only with caregivers you explicitly pair.
- You can delete your account and all associated data at any time from Settings → Account.

## 14. Troubleshooting

| Symptom                           | Try this                                                      |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Device won't power on             | Plug in for 10 min; if LED stays dark, try a different cable. |
| Wi-Fi not connecting              | Hold SELECT during boot to erase Wi-Fi, then redo setup.      |
| Talking but no reply              | Check Wi-Fi indicator on screen; ensure the volume is up.     |
| Recording cuts off mid-sentence   | Update to the latest firmware via the app.                    |
| SOS fires on its own              | Update firmware; if it persists, contact support.             |
| Caregiver not receiving alerts    | Verify caregiver email in app; check spam folder.             |
| Music plays tones instead of song | Server issue — try again in a few minutes.                    |

## 15. Safety information

- Mind Buddy provides supportive companionship; it is not a medical device and does not diagnose, treat or cure any condition.
- Always continue to follow advice from your doctor or mental-health professional.
- In a life-threatening crisis, call your local emergency services immediately.
- Keep the device away from extreme heat (>50°C) and prolonged direct sunlight.
- The lithium battery is non-removable; do not attempt to open the device.

## 16. Support & contact

Need help? Visit the Help section in your app or email [support@mindbuddy.ai](mailto:support@mindbuddy.ai). Include your device's 6-character code so we can find your setup quickly.